Changing the contents of a variable

To change the value of a variable, simply assign a new value to it. Here, the variable "gifts" has the value 2. It changes to 3 when it's assigned a new value.

```
>>> gifts = 2
>>> print(gifts)
2
>>> gifts = 3
>>> print(gifts)
3
```

Changes the value of the variable

Using variables

The value of one variable can be assigned to another one using the "=" sign. For example, if the variable "rabbits" contains the number of rabbits, we can use it to assign the same value to the variable "hats", so that each rabbit has a hat.

1 Assign the variables
This code assigns the number 5 to the variable "rabbits". It then assigns the same value to the variable "hats".

Variable name

Value assigned to the variable

```
>>> rabbits = 5
>>> hats = rabbits
```

"hats" now has the same value as "rabbits"

2 Print the values
To print two variables, put them both in brackets after the "print" command, and put a comma between them. Both "hats" and "rabbits" contain the value 5.

```
>>> print(rabbits, hats)
5 5
```

Leave a space after the comma

3 Change the value of "rabbits"
If you change the value of "rabbits", it doesn't affect the value of "hats". The "hats" variable only changes when you assign it a new value.

```
>>> rabbits = 10
>>> print(rabbits, hats)
10 5
```

Give "rabbits" a new value

Value for "hats" remains the same

EXPERT TIPS

Naming variables

There are some rules you have to follow when naming your variables:

All letters and numbers can be used.

You can't start with a number.

Symbols such as -, /, #, or @ can't be used.

Spaces can't be used.

An underscore (_) can be used instead of a space.

Uppercase and lowercase letters are different. Python treats "Dogs" and "dogs" as two different variables.

Don't use words Python uses as a command, such as "print".